



Ideation Techniques

What is Brainstorming?

Brainstorming is a creative technique used to generate ideas and solutions in a collaborative environment.

- Encourages free thinking and idea sharing
- Focuses on quantity over quality initially
- Helps uncover innovative design solutions



How to Conduct Brainstorming

- **Define the Problem:** Set a clear goal
- **Gather the Team:** Include diverse perspectives
- **Set a Time Limit:** Keep the session focused
- **Encourage Ideas:** No idea is too big or small
- **Evaluate and Refine:** Shortlist practical solutions



Best Practices

- Build on others' ideas
- Avoid criticism during ideation
- Focus on user pain points
- Use mind maps to connect ideas



What is Affinity Mapping?

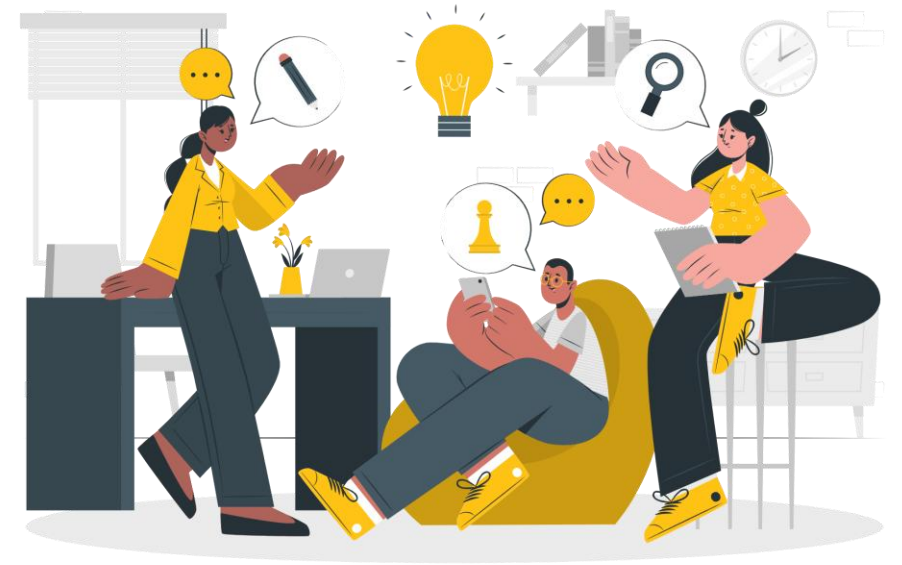
Affinity Mapping is used to organize and categorize ideas, data, or insights collected during research to find patterns and themes.

- Helps group similar ideas
- Identifies key focus areas
- Enables data-driven decision-making



Steps to Create an Affinity Map

- **Collect Data/Ideas:** Gather raw insights
- **Sort and Group:** Identify patterns
- **Label Groups:** Define categories
- **Analyze Patterns:** Prioritize findings
- **Derive Insights:** Use insights to inform design decisions



Tips for Success

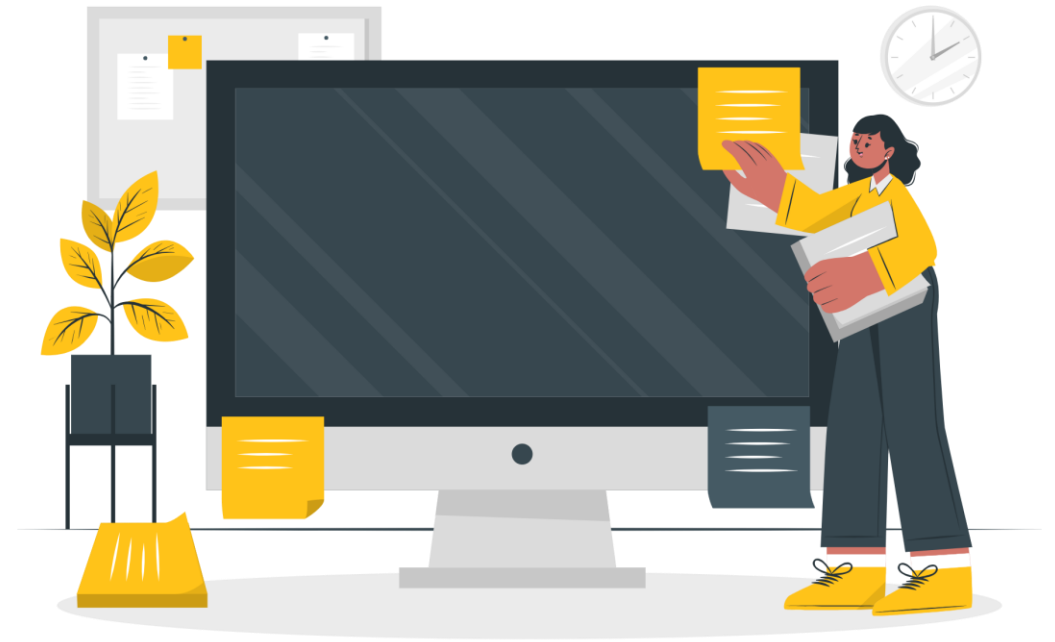
- Use sticky notes for easy sorting
- Involve stakeholders for multiple perspectives
- Cluster similar thoughts/ideas for better categorization
- Review and refine categories for relevance



What is Card Sorting?

Card Sorting is a usability technique that helps understand how users categorize and label content.

- Identifies user mental models
- Improves information architecture
- Informs intuitive navigation



Card Sorting Methods

- **Open Card Sorting:** Users create their own categories
- **Closed Card Sorting:** Users sort into predefined categories
- **Hybrid Card Sorting:** Mix of open and closed methods



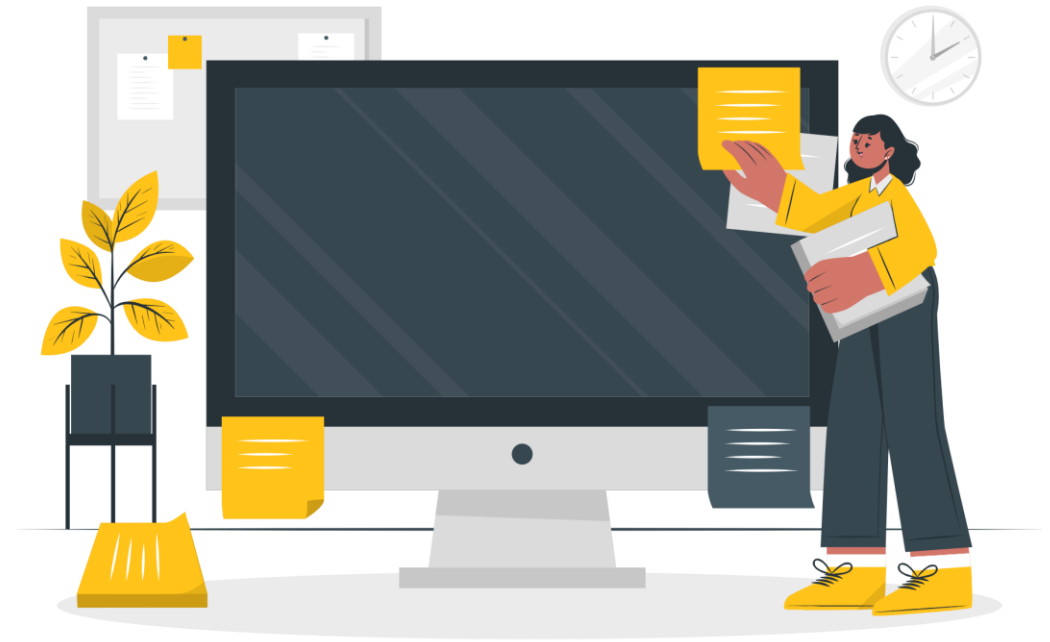
How to Conduct Card Sorting

- **Define Objectives:** Identify key information areas
- **Prepare Cards:** List key concepts or items
- **Choose Participants:** Target actual users
- **Facilitate the Session:** Encourage honest categorization
- **Analyze Results:** Identify common patterns



Why Use Card Sorting?

- Enhances information architecture
- Improves navigation and findability
- Reflects user expectations and behavior
- Reduces cognitive load for users

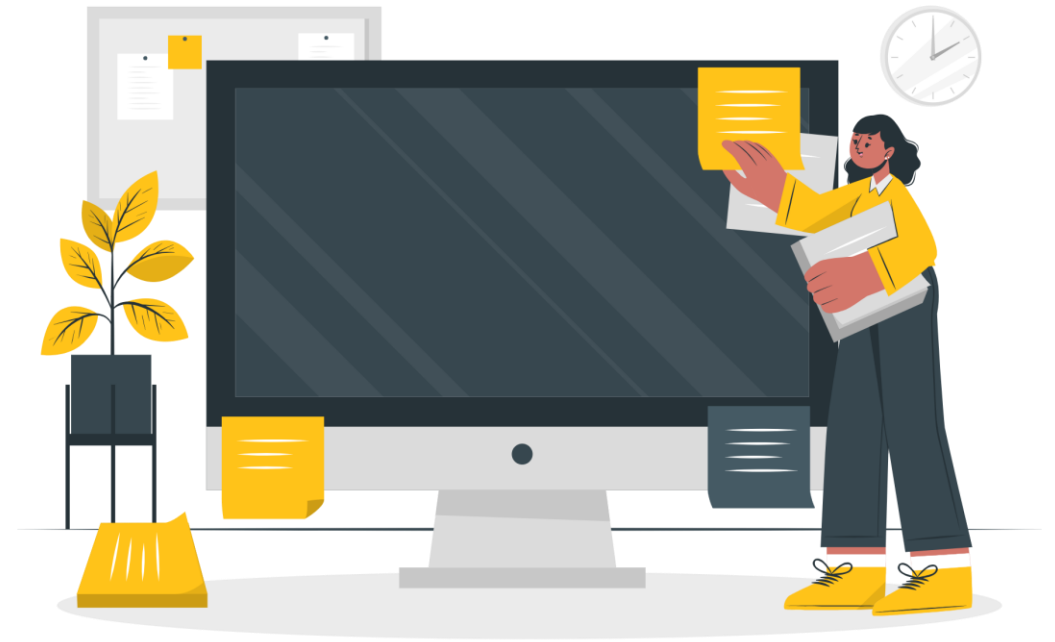


Comparing Techniques

Technique	Purpose	When to Use
Brainstorming	Idea Generation	Ideation Phase
Affinity Mapping	Organizing Ideas	Post-Brainstorming
Card Sorting	Structuring Information	Pre-Design Phase

Final Thoughts

Using Brainstorming, Affinity Mapping, and Card Sorting helps designers gain deep insights, structure information effectively, and create intuitive experiences aligned with user needs.





Thank you.